Demonstration only. Nore Valley Accountants is a fictional firm. Fees and terms are invented for a portfolio project.

Standard Engagement Terms

These terms apply to every client unless the client's engagement letter says otherwise.

1. Scope

1.1 We provide only the services listed in your engagement letter. Any other work is quoted separately before we start.

1.2 We prepare returns and accounts from the information you give us. We do not audit that information unless an audit is agreed in writing.

2. Tax advice

2.1 We do not give tax advice by email, phone message or chat.

2.2 Advice is given only in a consultation with a partner, or in a signed written letter of advice from a partner. Anything else from us, such as general information, links to Revenue guidance or admin replies, is not advice and should not be relied on as advice.

2.3 If you email us a question that needs advice, we will reply to arrange a consultation, or we will include it in your next scheduled meeting.

3. Your responsibilities

3.1 You are responsible for keeping complete and accurate business records and for the accuracy of the information you give us.

3.2 Records deadline for sole traders: send your full records for the previous tax year by **31 August**.

3.3 Records deadline for limited companies: send your full records within **3 months of your financial year end**.

3.4 Forward any letter, notice or email from Revenue to us within **2 working days** of receiving it. Late notices can lead to penalties and interest that we cannot prevent.

3.5 Tell us promptly about changes to your contact details, business activities, directors or shareholders.

4. Our responsibilities

4.1 If you meet the records deadline, we file your return or accounts by the relevant Revenue or CRO deadline.

4.2 We act as your tax agent with Revenue through ROS once you authorise us, and we receive copies of Revenue correspondence through that link.

4.3 We tell you the tax payable and the payment deadline before we file. Paying the tax is your responsibility.

5. Anti-money laundering

5.1 As accountants we are designated persons under the Criminal Justice (Money Laundering and Terrorist Financing) Act 2010. We must verify the identity of every new client, and of the beneficial owners of client companies, before we act.

5.2 We cannot start work until identity verification is complete. Verification decisions are made only by a partner.

5.3 We may ask for updated identification at any time.

6. Fees and payment

6.1 Our fees are set out in our engagement letter and our current Services and Fee Guide.

6.2 Invoices are payable within 14 days. We may pause work on accounts more than 30 days overdue.

7. Communication and response times

7.1 Our office hours are Monday to Friday, 9:00 to 17:30, excluding public holidays.

7.2 We aim to reply to emails within **2 working days**. Around the October and November tax deadlines, replies may take up to 4 working days. Urgent Revenue matters are always prioritised.

7.3 We never ask for passwords or one-time codes by email.

8. Data protection and records

8.1 We process personal data in line with the GDPR and our privacy notice.

8.2 We keep working papers for six years after the end of the tax year or accounting period they relate to.

9. Ending the engagement

9.1 Either party may end the engagement by giving 30 days' notice in writing. Fees for work already done remain payable.